

Brand Personas for Your Music Brand

Your Unique Position

You're a 35-year-old ML engineer who finally stopped playing music "on the side" and started sharing your story. Your songs blend 90s-2000s nostalgia with mature, introspective themes about love, heartbreak, philosophy, and self-discovery. You're multi-instrumental, genre-versatile, and willing to be vulnerable about what you've been through. This authenticity, combined with technical production skills and life experience, sets you apart in a sea of younger, less seasoned artists.

Your Core Appeal: Real emotion + nostalgic sound + production credibility + relatable life wisdom

Persona 1: The Fellow Traveler (Primary Target)

Demographics

- **Name:** Sarah
- **Age:** 32-42
- **Location:** Suburban/urban, likely has roots or career in tech/creative fields
- **Occupation:** Mid-career professional (tech, marketing, finance, healthcare), possibly parent

Psychographics

Values: Authenticity, emotional intelligence, personal growth, nostalgia for "their" era

Lifestyle: Work-life balance seeker, reflective, values meaningful connections over quantity

Music Habits: Spotify Deep Cuts listener, still has old CDs/playlists, discovers music through friends or thoughtful recommendations

Their Life Right Now

- Navigating career crossroads, relationships evolving or ending, questioning earlier life choices
- Successful on paper but feeling something's missing
- Craving art that reflects their complexity—not the simple emotions of their 20s
- Nostalgic for the 90s-2000s but doesn't want to just relive the past

Why Your Music Hits Different for Them

- **You're their peer** - not a kid trying to sound deep, not an aging rockstar, but someone in the same life stage
- **Your sound is their soundtrack** - the music they grew up with, done with modern maturity

- **Your themes reflect their questions** - love after heartbreak, second chapters, philosophy born from experience
- **Your story is relatable** - you had a "real job," life happened, and music became the outlet

Goals & Motivations

- Find music that validates and articulates their complex feelings
- Connect with artists who've "lived it" not just performed it
- Support authentic creators, not industry products
- Feel less alone in their journey

Pain Points

- Most new music feels emotionally shallow or aimed at younger audiences
- Tired of overproduced pop and cliché lyrics
- Can't relate to 22-year-olds singing about heartbreak anymore
- Frustrated by artists who lack substance or life experience

How They Engage with You

- Listens deeply and repeatedly - your songs become their therapy
- Follows your journey with genuine interest in YOU as a person
- Comments thoughtfully on posts, shares with select friends
- Will financially support (merch, Bandcamp, Patreon) when they feel the connection
- Attends intimate shows if you play their city

Content They Want from You

- **The story behind the songs** - what you went through, what the lyrics mean
- **Your journey from engineer to artist** - the courage to pivot resonates
- **Production breakdowns** - they respect the craft and skill
- **Philosophical musings** - thoughts on life, love, growth (written or video)
- **Acoustic versions** - stripped-down emotion hits them hardest
- **Honest updates** - not constant posting, but real check-ins

Key Message

"Your music feels like it was written for exactly where I am in life right now."

Persona 2: The Nostalgic Explorer

Demographics

- **Name:** Tyler
- **Age:** 24-30
- **Location:** Urban, digitally native
- **Occupation:** Early career creative (designer, developer, content creator, musician)

Psychographics

Values: Authenticity, craft, the "golden age" they missed

Lifestyle: Online community-oriented, side hustle culture, values learning from mentors

Music Habits: Algorithm-driven discovery, creates playlists by vibe/era, follows artists who make "real" music

Their Relationship with the 90s-2000s

- **Too young to have lived it fully** but romanticizes that era's music and culture
- Discovers bands like Radiohead, Deftones, Incubus, Third Eye Blind and thinks "why don't they make music like this anymore?"
- Craves the guitar-driven, vocally emotive sound that modern pop-punk revival only scratches
- Sees that era as more "authentic" than today's overproduced, algorithm-optimized music

Why Your Music Appeals to Them

- **You bridge past and present** - nostalgic sound with contemporary production quality
- **You're a "real musician"** - multi-instrumental, writes/produces your own stuff
- **Your tech background intrigues them** - they respect the analytical mind + artistry combo
- **You're accessible** - not an untouchable legacy artist, but someone actively building

Goals & Motivations

- Discover artists making "timeless" music in the 90s-2000s vein
- Learn from creators with real skills (production, songwriting, instrumentation)
- Support independent artists who do it themselves
- Build their own taste identity around quality over trends

Pain Points

- Tired of disposable, TikTok-bait music
- Wants substance but doesn't know where to find it
- Frustrated by artists who only show the highlight reel
- Craves mentorship or insights from people who've figured things out

How They Engage with You

- Discovers you via Spotify algorithm, YouTube recommendations, or Reddit threads
- Binges your catalog once they find you
- Actively shares your music in Discord servers, group chats, "hidden gems" threads
- Comments on production techniques, asks questions about your process
- Creates content inspired by your music (covers, reaction videos)

Content They Want from You

- **Behind-the-scenes production content** - how you got that guitar tone, vocal layering, mixing choices
- **Genre versatility showcased** - switching from rock to R&B shows your range
- **Your transition story** - proof that it's never too late to pursue your passion
- **Influences and references** - what 90s-2000s artists shaped you
- **"How I made this song" breakdowns** - they want to learn

Key Message

"You make the music I wish more artists still made. How did you do that?"

Persona 3: The Craft Appreciator

Demographics

- **Name:** Marcus
- **Age:** 28-45
- **Location:** Anywhere with a music scene (local or online)
- **Occupation:** Musician, producer, audio engineer, music teacher, serious hobbyist

Psychographics

Values: Musicianship, authenticity, technical skill, artistic integrity

Lifestyle: Deep in the music world (playing, producing, or both), community-focused

Music Habits: Listens analytically, follows production forums, supports DIY/independent artists

What They Respect About You

- **You're self-sufficient** - play multiple instruments, write, produce, record
- **You have life experience** - not chasing clout, doing it for real reasons
- **You balance tech and art** - ML engineer brain meets emotional songwriter
- **Your sound is intentional** - 90s-2000s isn't a gimmick, it's authentic to who you are
- **You're vulnerable** - willingness to share your story takes courage

Goals & Motivations

- Connect with fellow creators who take the craft seriously
- Support artists who do it "the right way" - independently, authentically
- Learn from peers' approaches to songwriting, production, career building
- Build a network of like-minded musicians

Pain Points

- Tired of industry-manufactured artists with no real skill
- Frustrated by "instant gratification" culture in music
- Wants to support independent artists but there's so much noise
- Misses when musicianship mattered more than follower count

How They Engage with You

- Deep dives into your production and songwriting choices
- Reaches out directly with thoughtful questions or collaboration ideas
- Shares your music in musician communities and forums
- Attends your shows and talks gear/process with you afterward
- May become a genuine friend/collaborator

Content They Want from You

- **Technical deep-dives** - DAW walkthroughs, mic setups, plugin chains

- **Songwriting process** - how you structure songs, find melodies, write lyrics
- **Honest career insights** - the challenges of balancing music with a career
- **Collaboration opportunities** - open to working with other indie artists
- **Philosophy on art** - why you make music, what it means to you

Key Message

"You're doing this the right way. Let's connect."

Persona 4: The Heartbreak Seeker

Demographics

- **Name:** Emma
- **Age:** 25-38
- **Location:** Any (emotional states transcend geography)
- **Occupation:** Variable - currently in life transition

Psychographics

Values: Emotional honesty, catharsis, feeling understood

Lifestyle: Currently processing loss (breakup, divorce, grief, major life change)

Music Habits: Therapeutic listener - music is how they process emotions

Where They Are Right Now

- Going through or recently emerged from significant heartbreak/loss
- Needs music that validates their pain without platitudes
- Searching for artists who've clearly "been there"
- Uses music as emotional release and companion through darkness

Why Your Music Finds Them

- **Your lyrics feel personal but universal** - specific enough to be real, relatable enough to be theirs
- **Your vocal delivery conveys genuine emotion** - soft, melancholic, raw when needed
- **Your themes mirror their journey** - heartbreak → self-inspection → hope
- **Your age/maturity shows** - this isn't puppy love angst, it's adult heartbreak

Goals & Motivations

- Feel less alone in their pain
- Process emotions through music that "gets it"
- Find hope that life gets better after heartbreak
- Connect with art that treats their experience with gravity

Pain Points

- Most love songs feel superficial or aimed at teenagers
- Can't relate to "everything's fine" positivity content
- Needs emotional depth, not pop platitudes
- Wants authenticity from artists who've lived real loss

How They Engage with You

- Finds you via "heartbreak playlist," late-night algorithm spirals, or friend recommendation
- Listens obsessively, often to same songs on repeat
- May not engage publicly but feels deep personal connection
- Saves your songs for vulnerable moments
- Eventually reaches out with a heartfelt message about what your music means

Content They Want from You

- **Emotional honesty about your experiences** - the real story, not sanitized
- **Songs that span the heartbreak journey** - pain, reflection, healing, growth
- **Vulnerability** - showing that it's okay to not be okay
- **Acoustic/stripped versions** - raw emotion without production buffer
- **Hope without toxic positivity** - acknowledgment that healing takes time

Key Message

"Your music understands what I'm going through. Thank you for putting it into words."

Your Personalized Strategy to Reach Each Persona

Platform Strategy Overview

Primary Platforms: Instagram, YouTube, Spotify (where you are now)

Secondary: TikTok (selectively), Email/Newsletter

Community: Reddit (r/90sMusic, r/IndieMusicFeedback, genre-specific), Discord

Strategy for The Fellow Traveler (Your Core Audience)

Why They're Your Foundation

These are your people—your peers who will become your most loyal supporters, financial backers, and word-of-mouth evangelists. They have disposable income, emotional investment capacity, and they're HUNGRY for music that speaks to their life stage.

Content Strategy

Instagram (3-4x per week):

- **Story behind the song series:** Carousel posts with lyrics + the real story (vulnerability = gold here)
- **"From the Vault" throwbacks:** Photos/videos from your 90s music days, progression to now
- **Reflective captions:** Don't just promote—share what you're thinking about, learning, processing
- **Life snapshots:** Balance of music + real life (the ML engineering world, balancing creativity with responsibility)

YouTube (2x per month minimum):

- **Acoustic living room sessions:** Just you, guitar/piano, stripped-down versions
- **"Making of" videos:** Show your home studio, how you produced a track
- **Talk-through videos:** 5-10 minutes on what a song is about, why you wrote it, what you learned
- **Vlogs documenting the journey:** "35-year-old finally releasing music—here's what I'm learning"

Email Newsletter (Monthly):

- This is your VIP channel for Fellow Travelers
- Longer form: what you've been working on, what life's been teaching you, philosophy thoughts
- Early access to new releases, behind-the-scenes content, personal updates
- They WILL read it—these folks want depth

Engagement Approach:

- Respond thoughtfully to every comment from this group—they're writing from the heart
- Create space for conversation: "What's your experience with heartbreak and growth?" type posts
- Feature their stories (with permission): "A listener told me this song helped them through..."

Musical Priorities for This Persona

- Lead with your most emotionally mature, introspective tracks
 - Prioritize acoustic versions and stripped-down performances
 - Don't shy away from melancholic, vulnerable material—that's what they need
 - Genre-hop naturally—they appreciate your versatility as a sign of depth
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Strategy for The Nostalgic Explorer

Why They Matter

They're your growth engine. They're digitally savvy, actively sharing music, and searching for artists like you. They'll amplify your reach if you give them the tools.

Content Strategy

TikTok/Instagram Reels (2-3x per week):

- **"This guitar tone is pure 2001" videos:** Show off specific 90s-2000s production techniques
- **Side-by-side comparisons:** "Incubus did it like this / here's my take on that sound"
- **Multi-instrument loops:** Record yourself layering guitar, bass, keys, vocals—they love versatility
- **Tech meets art moments:** Quick clips explaining how your ML brain approaches music production

YouTube (for this persona specifically):

- **Production breakdown videos:** "How I got that Third Eye Blind guitar sound"
- **Gear/plugin rundowns:** What DAW, plugins, instruments you use (they'll ask)
- **Genre-switching challenge videos:** "Writing a song in the style of [90s band]"
- **Covers of 90s-2000s deep cuts:** Show your roots, tap into algorithm discovery

Reddit Engagement:

- Share music in relevant subreddits (with community rules in mind)
- Participate in discussions about 90s-2000s music—be helpful, not promotional
- Share production tips in music production subreddits

- Your "engineer who finally released music" story is Reddit gold

Engagement Approach:

- Answer production/technique questions in detail—establish yourself as skilled
- Encourage covers and fan interpretations
- Create "challenges" occasionally (write a verse, recreate a sound, etc.)
- Shout out fan content that references your music

Musical Priorities for This Persona

- Lead with your most genre-versatile, production-heavy tracks
 - Showcase your instrumental skills (guitar solos, piano runs)
 - Don't be afraid of the heavier stuff—many nostalgic explorers love rock/metal
 - Create Spotify playlists: "Songs that influenced [your song name]"
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Strategy for The Craft Appreciator

Why They're Your Network

These are potential collaborators, advocates in musician communities, and validators who lend you credibility. Their word carries weight in music circles.

Content Strategy

YouTube (Monthly deep-dives):

- **Full production walkthroughs:** 20-30 minute videos breaking down a song from scratch
- **Songwriting process videos:** How you approach melody, structure, lyrics
- **Technical tutorials:** Specific techniques you've developed (mic'ing, mixing approaches, etc.)
- **"Balancing career and art" discussions:** Many musician-engineers will relate

Instagram (Selective but valuable):

- **Technical breakdowns in Stories:** Show your DAW, explain a specific mix decision
- **Gear posts:** What you're using and why (not sponsored, just honest)
- **Collaboration callouts:** "Looking for a bassist for a new track—DM me"

Direct Engagement:

- Respond in-depth to technical questions via DM
- Be open to collaboration inquiries from skilled musicians
- Join producer/musician Discord servers and be an active, helpful member
- Attend local open mics or songwriter meetups (if comfortable)—real connections matter

Music Forums/Communities:

- Gearslut, r/WeAreTheMusicMakers, r/musicproduction
- Share your journey, ask for feedback, offer help to others
- Your background gives you credibility in these spaces

Musical Priorities for This Persona

- Share alternate mixes, stems, instrumentals occasionally
 - Be transparent about your process, gear, mistakes
 - Prioritize tracks that showcase technical skill and musicianship
 - Consider releasing stripped-down "producer packs" for remix/study
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Strategy for The Heartbreak Seeker

Why They'll Find You (And Why It Matters)

You don't need to chase this persona—they'll find you when they need you. But when they do, they become some of your most emotionally invested listeners. They'll save your songs for years.

Content Strategy

Prioritize Discoverability:

- **Playlist placement:** Submit to "heartbreak," "sad songs," "healing" playlists on Spotify
- **Lyric focus:** Post lyric videos, quote graphics with your most resonant lines
- **YouTube lyric videos:** Simple, clean visuals with full lyrics—this is how they'll find and share your songs

Instagram/TikTok (When appropriate):

- **Lyric snippets over visuals:** Let the words speak (rain, nature, abstract visuals)
- **Vulnerable moments:** Talking about what inspired a heartbreak song (without oversharing)
- **Healing journey content:** Not toxic positivity, but real talk about growth after loss

Create Space for Connection:

- Occasional posts inviting people to share their stories (gently, with care)
- Feature anonymous listener messages (with permission) about how a song helped them
- Respond with empathy to DMs from people sharing their pain—your kindness matters

Be Searchable:

- Use relevant keywords in video descriptions, captions, titles
- "Songs about moving on," "music for heartbreak," "healing after divorce," etc.
- They're actively searching—make sure they can find you

Musical Priorities for This Persona

- Lead with your most emotionally raw, lyrically vulnerable tracks
- Acoustic versions are crucial—they need to feel the emotion directly
- Journey arc matters: pain → reflection → hope (show the full spectrum)
- Don't rush to "happy endings"—sit in the complexity

Important Note on This Persona

These listeners are in a vulnerable place. Your openness about your own experiences is powerful, but remember:

- You're an artist, not a therapist
 - Set boundaries around emotional labor
 - It's okay to not respond to every heavy DM
 - Your music is the gift—you don't owe anyone your personal crisis management
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Cross-Persona Content Calendar Framework

Weekly Content Mix (Adjust to your capacity)

Monday: Fellow Traveler Focus (reflective post, story behind the song, life update)

Wednesday: Nostalgic Explorer Focus (production content, technique video, 90s reference)

Friday: Musical content for all (new release, performance video, acoustic version)

Weekend: Craft Appreciator Focus (technical deep-dive, behind-the-scenes production)

Always Available for Heartbreak Seeker: Lyric content, searchable keywords, emotional accessibility

Monthly Rhythm

Week 1: Release new content (song, video, major post)

Week 2: Behind-the-scenes and making-of content

Week 3: Engagement-focused (Q&A, responding to comments, community building)

Week 4: Reflection and planning (newsletter, personal update, next steps)

Your Unique Advantages (Use These)

1. **The Tech Background:** You speak analytical and emotional—rare combo
 2. **Multi-Instrumental:** Content variety is built-in
 3. **Life Experience:** Authenticity you can't fake at 22
 4. **Production Skills:** You control your entire creative process
 5. **Emotional Availability:** Willing to be vulnerable = instant connection
 6. **90s-2000s Timing:** This sound is having a resurgence RIGHT NOW
 7. **No Industry Pressure:** Creative freedom to be yourself
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Key Success Metrics to Track

For Fellow Traveler:

- Email list growth
- Comment quality (not just quantity)
- Direct messages sharing personal connections
- Saves/Playlist adds on Spotify
- Merch/Bandcamp purchases

For Nostalgic Explorer:

- Shares and reposts
- YouTube engagement (likes, comments, watch time)
- Reddit/forum traction
- Follower growth rate
- Playlists you're added to

For Craft Appreciator:

- Collaboration inquiries

- Technical questions in comments
- Community forum engagement
- Fellow musician followers
- Feature/interview requests

For Heartbreak Seeker:

- Playlist placements (especially editorial)
 - Lyric video views
 - "This song saved me" type messages
 - Long-term listener retention (Spotify stats)
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Final Thoughts: Playing to Your Strengths

What Makes You Different: You're not trying to be 25 and viral. You're not chasing trends. You're a 35-year-old who lived life, learned some things, and has stories to tell through music that sounds like the era that shaped you. That's your superpower.

The Long Game: You're building creative fulfillment and sharing your story—not chasing quick wins. That means:

- Consistency over virality
- Depth over breadth
- Quality over quantity
- Community over crowd

Your personas aren't customers—they're fellow travelers, students, collaborators, and people who need your music.

Play to that. Be yourself. The right people will find you.